

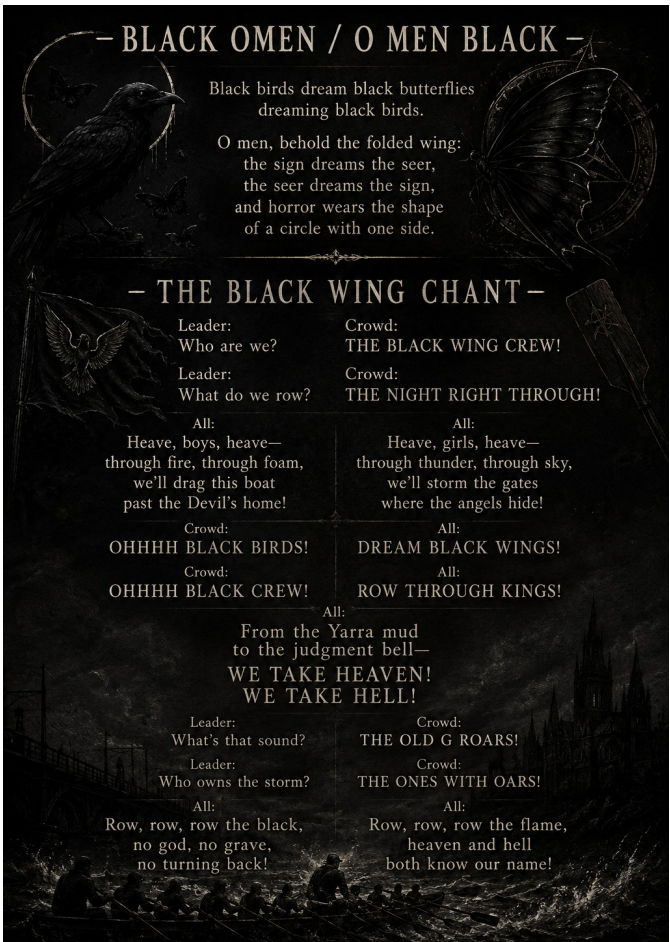
Black Omen / Black Wing Chant

Bunurong/Boonwurrung Deep Research Map

HTML5/PDF working document separating public word anchors, older leads, missing terms, grammar risks, cultural notes, and the next authority-request step.

Not an approved translation. This is a research scaffold only. Missing words, grammar, pronunciation and cultural fit require Bunurong/Boonwurrung authority confirmation before public release.

YouTube reference: <https://youtu.be/AVIo7JFKPbU?si=XQ3F-74K2iMdE1Nn>



Poster reference embedded from the supplied full-song image.

Core Finding

This project should be framed as a Bunurong/Boonwurrung language guidance request, not as a finished 'Koori translation'. Frankston sits on Bunurong Country, and Koori is a regional identity term, not one language.

The public record supports a layered working map: a small set of stronger public anchors, a set of older or mixed-source leads that need checking, and a large set of missing lyric terms that should not be invented.

Protocol / Safety

Do not call it translated yet. The official Bunurong language site states the dictionary is currently accessible only to Bunurong peoples. Public-facing use by non-Bunurong people needs permission, and direct translations are only provided when culturally appropriate.

Best framing: Black Omen / Black Wing Chant - Bunurong/Boonwurrung working language map.

Avoid: translated into Koori language.

Next step: send the request pack to the Bunurong language team / Bunurong Land Council CVRU language pathway.

Full Song Text

Title : BLACK OMEN / OMEN BLACK
Opening poem : Black birds dream black butterflies
Opening poem : dreaming black birds.
Opening poem : Omen, behold the folded wing:
Opening poem : the sign dreams the seer;
Opening poem : the seer dreams the sign,
Opening poem : and horror wears the shape
Opening poem : of a circle with one side.
Chant title : THE BLACK WING CHANT
Call / response [Leader]: Who are we?
Call / response [Crowd]: THE BLACK WING CREW!
Call / response [Leader]: What do we row?
Call / response [Crowd]: THE NIGHT RIGHT THROUGH!
Heave verse [All]: Heave, boys, heave -
Heave verse [All]: through fire, through foam,
Heave verse [All]: we'll drag this boat
Heave verse [All]: past the Devil's home!
Heave verse [All]: Heave, girls, heave -
Heave verse [All]: through thunder, through sky,
Heave verse [All]: we'll storm the gates
Heave verse [All]: where the angels hide!
Crowd hits [Crowd]: OHHHH BLACK BIRDS!
Crowd hits [All]: DREAM BLACK WINGS!
Crowd hits [Crowd]: OHHHH BLACK CREW!
Crowd hits [All]: ROW THROUGH KINGS!
Middle vow [All]: From the Yarra mud
Middle vow [All]: to the judgment bell -
Middle vow [All]: WE TAKE HEAVEN!
Middle vow [All]: WE TAKE HELL!
Final call [Leader]: What's that sound?
Final call [Crowd]: THE OLD G ROARS!
Final call [Leader]: Who owns the storm?
Final call [Crowd]: THE ONES WITH OARS!
Final chorus [All]: Row, row, row the black,
Final chorus [All]: no god, no grave,
Final chorus [All]: no turning back!
Final chorus [All]: Row, row, row the flame,
Final chorus [All]: heaven and hell
Final chorus [All]: both know our name.

Audited Public Word Bank

English	Candidate Word	Status	Confidence	Pronunciation	Notes
hello	Wawa	HAVE	High	WUH-wuh	Official public common word; useful for opening a learning page, not part of main lyric.
welcome	Wumindjika	HAVE	High	WOO-min-JEE-ku h	Official public common word. Wominjeka is Woiwurrung spelling, not the Bunurong spelling.
Country	Biik	HAVE	High	BEAK	Official public common word. Good for project framing, not necessarily part of Black Omen lyric.
no	Burrak	HAVE	High		Useful anchor for 'no turning back', but does not translate the whole phrase.
good / well / healthy / nice / great	Manamiiyt	HAVE	High		Official public common word; not central to lyric but useful for context.
yes	A-a	HAVE	High		Official public common word; not central to lyric.
crow	Waang	HAVE	Medium-High	WAHNG	Safer to use as crow than generic 'bird'. Use respectfully due to cultural associations.
butterfly / moth	Balambalam	HAVE	High	BUH-lum BUH-lum	Publicly supported by school-naming sources after Traditional Owner/community consultation.
dream	Yarragineneit	HAVE / ASK	Medium	YARR-uh-gi-neh-n ayt	Publicly recorded as 'Dream'. Must check whether it works as dreams/dreaming/to dream in lyric grammar.
ceremony / coming together to celebrate	Ngargee / Ngarrgee	HAVE / ASK	Medium-High	NAR-ghee	Good ceremonial/celebratory context. Do not force it to mean ordinary song or chant without authority confirmation.
black	cooyung	THINK	Low-Medium	KOO-yung	Older public vocabulary lead only. Not found in current official public common-word set.
dark	buruny	THINK	Low-Medium	BUH-ruh-ny	Older public vocabulary lead. Useful atmosphere word but verify spelling and current use.
one	canbo	THINK	Low-Medium		Older public vocabulary lead. Needed for 'one side', but side/circle remain missing.
thunder	murrndabil	THINK	Low-Medium	MURN-dah-bil	Older public vocabulary lead. Verify before public use.
sky	wurra-wurra	THINK	Low-Medium	WOO-ruh WOO-ruh	Older and historical/public lead. Current spelling needs checking.
wind	murnmut	THINK	Low-Medium		Wind does not equal storm. Do not use it as storm without guidance.
sea	warriny	THINK	Low-Medium	WAH-ri-ny	Related spellings appear in public materials; current standard spelling needs checking.
river	warraniit	THINK	Low-Medium		Older public lead; related spellings differ in other materials. Verify.
hut / camp	wilam / willum	HAVE / ASK	Medium		Supported for hut/camp; not automatically poetic 'home'.
old	wygabil / weegabeel	THINK	Low-Medium		Public leads vary by spelling/context. Better keep 'Old G' in English unless adapted by speaker.
children / baby	bubup	THINK	Low-Medium		Does not equal boys/girls. Cross-language caution.
fire	wiiny	THINK	Low-Medium	WEE-ny	Public Boon Wurrung narrative source gives fire; still verify for current Bunurong standard.

Missing / Unresolved Lyric Terms

Term / Group	Reason	Suggested Action	Priority
omen	No traceable public candidate found; may need poetic adaptation.	Ask authority	High
sign	No traceable public candidate found; abstract/context-sensitive.	Ask authority	High
seer	Missing and culturally risky; spiritual role term should not be improvised.	Ask authority	High
behold	Likely requires adaptation rather than literal translation.	Ask authority	Medium
folded	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	Medium
wing	Central blocker for 'Black Wing'.	Ask authority	High
shape	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	Medium
circle	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	High
side	No public candidate found; only 'one' has a lower-confidence lead.	Ask authority	High
song	No clean public ordinary 'song'; Ngargee is ceremony/celebration context, not simple song.	Ask authority	High
chant	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	High
crew	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	High
row / rowing	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	High
oar / oars	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	High
night	No traceable public candidate found in reviewed sources.	Ask authority	Medium
foam	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	Medium
boat	No public candidate found.	Ask authority	Medium
devil / angel / heaven / hell	Imported cosmological terms; likely better adapted or kept in English.	Keep English or ask	High
judgment / bell / grave	No public candidates found; abstract or context-dependent.	Ask authority	Medium
turning back	Burrak = no, but full phrase unresolved.	Ask authority	High
name / know / take / through / who / what / we / our	Function words and grammar need language authority, not word stacking.	Ask authority	High

Line-by-Line Working Map

Section	Original Line	Working Skeleton	Status	Unresolved / Notes
Opening poem	Black birds dream black butterflies	cooyung waang yarragineneit balambalam	PARTIAL	Cooyung older-only; waang safest as crow; yarragineneit verb use unconfirmed; plural and word order unverified.
Opening poem	dreaming black birds.	yarragineneit cooyung waang	PARTIAL	Participial 'dreaming' and syntax unresolved.
Opening poem	Omen, behold the folded wing:	[OMEN] [BEHOLD] [FOLDED] [WING]	MISSING	Line almost completely blocked in public corpus.
Opening poem	the sign dreams the seer;	[SIGN] yarragineneit [SEER]	BLOCKED	Sign and seer missing; dream-as-verb unverified.
Opening poem	the seer dreams the sign,	[SEER] yarragineneit [SIGN]	BLOCKED	Same blockers as previous line.
Opening poem	and horror wears the shape	[HORROR] [WEARS] [SHAPE]	MISSING	No usable public equivalents located.
Opening poem	of a circle with one side.	[CIRCLE] canbo [SIDE]	BLOCKED	Circle/side/with missing; canbo older-only; concept may need adaptation.
Chant title	THE BLACK WING CHANT	cooyung [WING] [CHANT]	BLOCKED	Wing and chant missing.
Call / response	THE BLACK WING CREW!	cooyung [WING] [CREW]	BLOCKED	Wing and crew missing.
Heave verse	through thunder, through sky,	[THROUGH] murrndabil, [THROUGH] wurra-wurra	PARTIAL	Through missing; current standard/spelling needs checking.
Middle vow	WE TAKE HEAVEN! / WE TAKE HELL!	[WE TAKE] [HEAVEN] / [WE TAKE] [HELL]	KEEP ENGLISH / ASK	Imported Christian concepts; likely adapt or keep English unless advised.
Final chorus	no god, no grave, no turning back!	Burrak [GOD], Burrak [GRAVE], Burrak [TURNING BACK]	BLOCKED	Only 'no' available; god/grave/turning back remain unresolved.

Safe Demo Chant Options

Option	Chant Words	Meaning	Notes
Conservative demo chant	Waang / Balambalam / Yarragineneit / Ngargee	Crow / Butterfly-moth / Dream / Ceremony-coming together to celebrate	Public word collage only; not approved translation.
Expanded research draft	Cooyung Waang / Balambalam / Yarragineneit / Murrndabil / Wurra-wurra / Warriny / Wiiny	Black crow / Butterfly-moth / Dream / Thunder / Sky / Sea / Fire	Includes older or mixed-source leads; verify before public use.
Poster anchor	Cooyung Waang / Cooyung Balambalam / Yarragineneit / Burrak [turning back]	Black crow / Black butterfly / Dream / No [turning back unresolved]	Good visual learning anchor, but not a full lyric translation.

Cultural and Grammar Notes

Dream / Dreaming

Yarragineneit is publicly mapped to dream, but the lyric needs dreams/dreaming/to dream grammar. Do not confuse ordinary dream with The Dreaming.

Omen / Seer / Sign

Spiritually charged and abstract. No public equivalents found; needs Bunurong authority or poetic English retention.

Waang / Crow

Crow has cultural/spiritual associations across Kulin contexts. Strong word, but use with respect and confirmation.

Heaven / Hell / Devil / Angel

Imported Christian cosmological words. Better kept in English or adapted after advice rather than forced into Bunurong.

Ngargee

Supported as ceremony/coming together to celebrate; not a simple one-word replacement for song/chant.

Authority Request Pack

Copy/paste request draft:

Hello,

I am preparing a lyric project connected to Frankston / Bunurong Country and would like guidance on whether parts of it can be translated or adapted into Bunurong/Boonwurrung.

I have only used publicly traceable words so far and do not want to misuse language or present unapproved material as translation.

The main lyric is:

Black birds dream black butterflies
dreaming black birds.

Omen, behold the folded wing:
the sign dreams the seer;
the seer dreams the sign,
and horror wears the shape
of a circle with one side.

Public words I have found include:

Waang = crow

Balambalam = butterfly/moth

Yarragineneit = dream

Ngargee = ceremony / coming together to celebrate

Burak = no

Biik = Country

and older public leads such as cooyung, murrndabil, wurra-wurra, warriny and wiiny.

Could you please advise which words are appropriate, which remain unresolved, and whether "dream" can be used in lyric phrases such as "the sign dreams the seer"?

Kind regards,
Tom

Who To Approach

Organisation	Contact / Pathway	Purpose
Bunurong Language Team	language.team@bunurong-language.org / linguist@bunuronglc.org.au	Ask about words, grammar, pronunciation and permission pathway.
Bunurong Land Council Aboriginal Corporation	CVRU Language Inception / Language and Naming pathway	Formal route for language project approval or referral.
Victorian Aboriginal Corporation for Languages	03 9600 3811 / info@vaclang.org.au	Language revitalisation support and referral; defer to Bunurong authority for Bunurong Country use.

Source Notes

Frankston City Council - Indigenous communities

Frankston Council acknowledges Bunurong people as Traditional Owners/custodians.

<https://www.frankston.vic.gov.au/Community-and-Health/Community-development-and-engagement/Indigenous-communities>

State Library Victoria - Koori Victoria

Koori is a regional identity term, not one language.

<https://www.slv.vic.gov.au/search-discover/explore-collections-theme/koori-victoria>

Bunurong Language - Official home

Official Bunurong language site; dictionary access currently only for Bunurong peoples.

<https://bunurong-language.org/>

Bunurong Language - Common words

Current public common words and pronunciation examples.

<https://bunurong-language.org/common-words/>

Bunurong Language - FAQ

Permission guidance for non-Bunurong people using Bunurong language.

<https://bunurong-language.org/faq/>

Bunurong Language - Reawakening

Explains reconstruction, peer review, and community review.

<https://bunurong-language.org/reawakening-boonwurrung/>

Bunurong Land Council - Our Services

Language projects involve consultation; direct translations provided only if culturally appropriate.

<https://www.bunuronglc.org/our-services.html>

Bunurong Land Council - Book a Meeting

CVRU Language Inception / Language and Naming pathway.

<https://www.bunuronglc.org/book-a-meeting.html>

Bunurong contact

Language team contact pathway.

<https://bunurong-language.org/contact-us/>

VACL - Boonwurrung program

Language revitalisation support and referral.

<https://vacl.org.au/language/boonwurrung/>

Mornington Peninsula Council minutes, 28 July 2020

Public council record includes Yarragineneit = Dream.

<https://www.mornpen.vic.gov.au/files/assets/public/new-website-documents/about-us/meetings-amp-minutes/2020/minutes-2020/council-meeting-minutes-28-july-2020.pdf>

Victorian School Building Authority - Balambalam Primary School

Balambalam meaning butterfly/moth, chosen with consultation.

<https://www.schoolbuildings.vic.gov.au/balambalam-primary-school>

City of Casey - History of Western Port

Public source noting Waang the Crow in Bunurong/Kulin creation context.

<https://www.casey.vic.gov.au/history-of-western-port>

AIATSIS - Ngargee

Ngargee described as coming together to celebrate in Boonwurrung language.

<https://aiatsis.gov.au/whats-new/news/ngargee-coming-together-celebrate-southeast-australian-aboriginal-art>

Wala Connections - Boonwurrung Ngargee Dance Group

Ngargee in ceremony/dance/cultural context.

<https://www.walaconnections.com/boonwurrungngargeedancegroup>

Early History 4 Clyde - Bunurong language list

Older public vocabulary list; useful leads but not current official spelling/approval.

<https://www.earlyhistory4clydevic.com/html/0202bunuronglanguage.html>

Mornington Peninsula coastal/cultural material

Public Boon Wurrung/Bunurong cultural context and related vocabulary/spellings.

https://www.mornpen.vic.gov.au/files/assets/public/new-website-documents/about-us/meetings-amp-minutes/2017/attachments-2017/172410ca__att_35_1.pdf